

Activity Guide — middle / module-04-doshas

IKS Curriculum

Table of Contents

Activity 1 — Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Middle · **Duration:** 30 min

Purpose

Reinforce the day-by-day concepts of Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha through a hands-on activity. Aligned with NEP 2020 §4.23 (experiential learning).

Materials

circular paper plate, coloured markers, ruler

What students do

Students mark a 24-hour clock face into three doṣa segments — kapha (6–10 am and 6–10 pm), pitta (10 am–2 pm and 10 pm–2 am), vāta (2–6 am and 2–6 pm). They note one personal activity that fits each segment and share with a partner.

Step-by-step

1. **Setup (5 min)** — gather materials; explain the task.
2. **Working phase (20 min)** — students work individually or in pairs.
3. **Share (5 min)** — selected students share their results with the class.

Differentiation

- **Extension:** ask advanced students to do an additional iteration or analysis.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial templates.

Assessment

This activity is **formative**. The teacher observes participation, accuracy, and reflection quality. No grade is assigned.

Safety

- General safety briefing before any materials are handled.

- If herbs, plants, or food are involved: kitchen-amount only, no ingestion of unknown preparations.
- Outdoor activities: stay in the designated area; supervised by the teacher.

Activity 01 — Qualities Sort

Module: Doṣas · **Band:** Middle · **Day:** 4 · **Time:** 25 min (within Day 4's 45 min)

Type

Hands-on classification, paired

Goal

Pairs sort 30 cards naming objects/qualities/activities into the three *doṣa* trays, with reasoned justification and visible disagreement on borderline cases.

Materials per class

- 30 prepared cards (see card list below)
- 3 paper trays / chalk-circle on floor, each labelled with one *doṣa*
- A notebook per pair for *why* notes
- Sticky notes for disagreements

Card list (prepare 30 cards before class)

Mix of qualities, foods, weather, activities, sensations, behaviours:

1. dry wind
2. ice cream
3. running fast
4. warm khichdi
5. raw celery
6. fresh ginger tea
7. hot summer noon
8. deep dreamless sleep
9. cold mountain air
10. chocolate cake
11. ghee on rice
12. boiled rice with pickle
13. peeling skin
14. heavy oily curry
15. shouting in anger
16. quick fidget
17. monsoon humidity

18. brisk walking
19. milk before bed
20. fasting all day
21. spicy chili
22. cool yoghurt
23. dry crackers
24. long afternoon nap
25. evening jog
26. soft pillow nap
27. crisp autumn morning
28. steaming dāl
29. cold lemonade
30. sudden cough

Set-up (teacher, before class)

- Print or hand-write 30 cards.
- Lay out 3 trays in three corners of the room, each clearly labelled with a *doṣa* name in IAST + English.
- One pair starts at each tray with 10 random cards. Plan rotation so no two pairs hold the same card.

Instructions (student-facing — printable handout)

Qualities Sort — work in pairs.

1. Take 6 cards from the deck.
2. For each card, decide which *doṣa* it most affects (or *belongs to*). Place it on the matching tray.
3. In your notebook, write a 1-line *why* for each placement.
4. **Disagree with your partner?** Argue. Write both placements. Circle the one you finally vote for.
5. After 15 min, swap your full set with another pair. They check your placements.
6. **Gallery walk (last 5 min):** if you disagree with another pair's placement, write a sticky note explaining why (kindly).

Worksheet (one per pair)

#	Card phrase	We placed on	Why (1 line)	Disagreement ?
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				

#	Card phrase	We placed on	Why (1 line)	Disagreement ?
6				

Suggested “right answer” key (teacher use only — flexibility OK)

Card	Likely doṣa	Reasoning
dry wind	vāta	dry + mobile + cold
ice cream	kapha	cold + heavy + sweet
running fast	vāta (could be pitta if competitive)	mobile, light
warm khichdi	calms vāta	warm, oily, soft
raw celery	vāta-aggravating	dry, light, raw
fresh ginger tea	calms kapha	warm, pungent
hot summer noon	pitta	hot, sharp
deep dreamless sleep	kapha	heavy, slow
cold mountain air	vāta	cold, dry, mobile
chocolate cake	kapha	heavy, sweet, oily
ghee on rice	calms vāta	oily, sweet, grounding
boiled rice with pickle	balanced (calms vāta)	warm, soft + sour
peeling skin	vāta	dry
heavy oily curry	kapha	heavy, oily
shouting in anger	pitta	hot, sharp
quick fidget	vāta	mobile
monsoon humidity	kapha (cold) + vāta (mobile)	mixed
brisk walking	calms kapha	warming, moving
milk before bed	calms vāta	sweet, warm, oily
fasting all day	aggravates vāta	dry, light
spicy chili	aggravates pitta	hot, sharp
cool yoghurt	aggravates kapha	cold, heavy
dry crackers	vāta	dry, light
long afternoon nap	aggravates kapha	heavy, slow
evening jog	balances kapha	moving, warming
soft pillow nap	kapha	heavy, restful

Card	Likely doṣa	Reasoning
crisp autumn morning	vāta	dry, cool, light
steaming dāl	calms vāta	warm, soft, sweet
cold lemonade	aggravates kapha (cold), calms pitta (sour-sweet)	mixed
sudden cough	depends on context — see Day 7 (could be kapha imbalance OR medical)	borderline

Notes for the teacher: - “monsoon humidity” and “cold lemonade” are deliberately mixed — let the disagreement unfold. - “sudden cough” is the link to Day 7 (when to see a doctor). Don’t resolve it.

Looks-like / sounds-like

	Looks like	Sounds like
Going well	Both partners arguing kindly; pen on notebook; cards moving	“But it’s heavy — it has to be kapha.” / “Yes but it’s also cold.” / “Then it’s mostly kapha with some vāta.”
Needs intervention	One partner placing all the cards; rows filled with one word	Silence; “I don’t know, write anything.”

Safety / sensitivity

- No actual food handling (all cards). The food cards reference foods only by name.
- No comments on classmates’ bodies, eating habits, or health.
- If a student feels singled out by a card (“heavy oily curry”), reframe immediately — we’re sorting *qualities*, not people.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** After sorting, the pair picks 3 cards and writes a 1-paragraph defense for each — including *why the other two doṣas almost worked too*.
- **Tier down:** Sort just 10 cards across 3 doṣas. Skip the mixed ones.

Clean-up

- Cards back in deck for next class.
- Worksheets stay in student notebooks for revision.
- Teacher takes a quick photograph of the 3 trays for the day-record.

Activity 02 — Taste Station Rotation

Module: Doṣas · **Band:** Middle · **Day:** 6 · **Time:** 20 min (within Day 6’s 45 min)

Type

Sensory rotation, paired

Goal

Students sample all six *ṣaḍ-rasa* (six tastes), identify each in IAST + English, and predict which *doṣa* each calms.

Materials per class

- Six labelled stations around the room. Each station has:
 - The sample (covered until needed)
 - A label: Sanskrit name + IAST + English
 - A worksheet question card
 - Toothpicks for sampling
 - A small bin for used toothpicks
- One glass of water + small cup per student for rinsing between stations
- Worksheet for each pair (template below)

Suggested samples per station

Station	Sanskrit	English	Sample	Backup if allergy
1	<i>madhura</i>	sweet	a piece of jaggery / date / raisin	sugar cube
2	<i>amla</i>	sour	a wedge of lemon / a pinch of amla powder	a single grape
3	<i>lavaṇa</i>	salty	a few grains of rock salt	regular salt
4	<i>kaṭu</i>	pungent	a small piece of fresh ginger (let them smell)	a peppercorn (sniff only)
5	<i>tikta</i>	bitter	a methi leaf / a single neem leaf / dark	bitter gourd slice

Station	Sanskrit	English	Sample	Backup if allergy
6	<i>kaṣāya</i>	astringent	chocolate (>70%) a piece of unripe banana / a few sips of strong black tea	a pomegranate seed

Set-up (teacher, before class)

- Lay out 6 stations clearly spaced.
- Cover each sample with a small cloth or upside-down cup so students can't pre-judge.
- Pre-circulate a quick **allergy/dietary check** at least one day before. Note any students who must opt out of specific samples.
- Have water and rinse cups within easy reach of every station.

Instructions (student-facing — printable handout)

Six Tastes — work in pairs. 2 minutes per station.

1. Lift the cover. Look at the sample. Smell it.
2. **Either** taste a small bite (one toothpick-tip) **or** smell-only. No pressure to taste.
3. On the worksheet, write:
 - (a) the Sanskrit name in IAST + English
 - (b) one descriptor word (cooling, warming, sharp, mild, drying)
 - (c) which *doṣa* you'd predict it calms
 - (d) which *doṣa* you'd predict it aggravates
4. Rinse mouth between stations with the water.
5. Rotate clockwise to the next station.

Worksheet (one per pair)

#	Station name (IAST + English)	Descript or	I predict it calms...	I predict it aggravates...
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

Answer key (for the debrief)

Station	Calms	Aggravates	Note
<i>madhura</i> (sweet)	vāta, pitta	kapha	grounding, heavy
<i>amla</i> (sour)	vāta	pitta, kapha	warming, slightly heating
<i>lavaṇa</i> (salty)	vāta	pitta, kapha	warming, water-retaining
<i>kaṭu</i> (pungent)	kapha	vāta, pitta	hot, sharp, drying
<i>tikta</i> (bitter)	pitta, kapha	vāta	cooling, light, drying
<i>kaṣāya</i> (astringent)	pitta, kapha	vāta	cool, dry, drawing-in

Discussion prompts (5 min after rotation)

- Which taste surprised you? Why?
- Which one tastes “Indian” most familiar? Why?
- Most plates from your home — how many of the six show up?
- The classical view: a *balanced meal* hits all six. What does your typical dinner miss?

Safety / sensitivity

- **No forced tasting.** Smell-only is fine.
- **Allergy opt-out without question.** Especially for nuts (avoid), citrus (some are sensitive), neem (rare allergy possible).
- No comparison of students’ choices. (“Why don’t YOU taste it?” — disallow.)
- Diabetic students should not taste the sweet station — use a sugar-free alternative.
- Hand hygiene: hand-sanitiser before and after.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** For each taste, predict whether it’s appropriate for hot summer noon vs cold winter morning. Defend.
- **Tier down:** Do three stations only — sweet, sour, salty. The other three can be smell-only.

Clean-up

- Used toothpicks in the bin per station.
- Wipe stations.
- Recycle paper labels for next time.

Activity 03 — Scope Debate: Lifestyle or Doctor?

Module: Doṣas · **Band:** Middle · **Day:** 7 · **Time:** 15 min (within Day 7’s 45 min)

Type

Paired discussion, structured scenarios

Goal

Students decide whether each scenario belongs in “lifestyle range — observe + adjust” or “medical territory — see a doctor,” practising the safety boundary in their own words.

Materials per class

- 10 scenario cards (template below)
- 2 large signs: **LIFESTYLE** and **MEDICAL**
- Class divides into 5 pairs (or however many pairs fit your class)

Set-up (teacher, before class)

- Print and cut 10 scenario cards.
- Pin the two large signs on opposite walls.
- Pairs gather mid-room; cards are face-down in a stack.

Instructions (student-facing — printable handout)

Scope Debate — work in pairs. 5 scenario rounds.

1. Each pair draws a card. Read it together.
2. Discuss for 60 seconds. Decide: lifestyle range or medical territory? Why?
3. When the teacher calls time, each pair stands closer to the wall sign matching their decision. Pairs in the middle = “we couldn’t agree” or “depends.”
4. The teacher picks 2 pairs to share their reasoning. Disagreement is welcomed.
5. Draw the next card.

Scenario cards (10)

Card 1. Aarav, 13, has had dry, flaky skin on his hands for 3 days during a cold-dry winter week. He’s eating his usual diet and sleeping normally.

Card 2. Priya, 12, has had a wet, productive cough for 3 weeks. It started after a cold and has not improved. She’s tired in the afternoons.

Card 3. Karan, 14, gets sharp acidity / heartburn whenever he eats spicy chili. He notices it happens only after spicy meals.

Card 4. Riya, 13, has had heartburn that wakes her up at 2 am every night for the last 2 weeks. It happens whether she eats spicy food or not.

Card 5. Devansh, 12, is restless and chatty after exam stress. Two weeks of exams. He says his sleep is broken some nights.

Card 6. Sneha, 14, has had a panic feeling at school that lasts 45 minutes and made her unable to go to class. It has happened 3 times this month.

Card 7. Aarush, 13, feels sluggish on rainy mornings during monsoon. He'd rather not wake up. He's fine by mid-morning.

Card 8. Maya, 12, has been unable to wake up for school for 3 weeks. She sleeps 12+ hours and still feels exhausted. She has lost interest in sports.

Card 9. Vivaan, 13, gets gassy and bloated after eating raw salad. He's noticed the pattern over 2 months. Otherwise fine.

Card 10. Anika, 14, has had a sharp pain in her right lower abdomen for the last 4 hours. It started mild and is now severe. She also has a slight fever.

Suggested teacher framing (after each round)

Card	Likely answer	Teaching point
1	lifestyle	brief, mild, matches <i>vāta</i> season — try oil on hands
2	medical	persistent cough > 2 weeks; the <i>kapha</i> framing doesn't replace seeing a doctor
3	lifestyle	observable cause (spicy food), brief, predictable — eat less spicy
4	medical	persistent, wakes from sleep — needs evaluation
5	lifestyle	situational, time-limited (exams) — <i>vāta</i> -calming may help
6	medical	impairs functioning, recurrent — needs counsellor / clinician
7	lifestyle	mild, seasonal, brief, <i>kapha</i> -pattern in monsoon
8	medical	3 weeks of major fatigue + loss of interest — possibly depression; needs help
9	lifestyle	observable pattern, mild, <i>vāta</i> -aggravation from raw food — try cooked vegetables instead
10	medical (emergency)	acute severe pain + fever — possible appendicitis. Doctor immediately.

Discussion prompts (5 min, after all rounds)

- Which card was hardest to call? Why?
- Where is the line for YOU between “I’ll adjust my routine” and “I’ll tell my parents I need a doctor”?
- What’s the cost of being wrong in each direction? (Treating a medical issue as lifestyle = harm. Treating a lifestyle issue as medical = anxiety + cost.)

Looks-like / sounds-like

	Looks like	Sounds like
Going well	Pairs in active discussion; movement between walls	“Three days isn’t long enough.” / “But it’s been getting worse.” / “Then it tips medical.”
Needs intervention	One partner deciding, the other agreeing without thought	“It says it’s mild, so lifestyle.” (Without considering duration.)

Safety / sensitivity

- The scenarios are deliberately not about anyone in the class. Don’t ask students to share personal medical info.
- If a card prompts a student to mention their own real symptom — quietly check in after class, refer to school nurse / counsellor if needed.
- The answer key is a teaching guide, not a diagnostic key. Real medical decisions are made by clinicians, not classroom cards.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** For each medical card, students name which kind of specialist (general physician, dermatologist, mental-health counsellor, emergency) would be the right first stop.
- **Tier down:** Focus on 5 of the 10 cards. Make sure they get the obvious-emergency one (card 10).

Clean-up

- Cards back in the stack for next class.
- Worksheets (none today — discussion-only) stay verbal.

Project Brief

Project Brief — Seven-Day Doṣa Self-Observation

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Middle

What you will do

Chart your daily routine — sleep, food, energy, mood — for 7 days through the doṣa lens. Write a one-page reflection. THIS IS NOT DIAGNOSIS. Refer any health concern to a doctor.

Why

This project asks you to apply concepts from this module to your own life or a real situation. It is graded on the rubric in `rubric.md`.

Deliverables

- **One-page project plan** (Day 2 of the module): problem, sources, deliverable, timeline.
- **Daily journal entries** (one per day, starting Day 6): what you did, what worked, what didn't.
- **Final artefact** (a poster / model / digital deliverable).
- **Written reflection** (300 words (Middle)): what you learned, what surprised you, what you're still uncertain about.
- **Presentation** (5-minute share with the class).

Timeline

- **Day 1–2:** scope and plan.
- **Day 3–4:** research.
- **Day 5:** mid-project critique.
- **Day 6–7:** build / make.
- **Day 8:** document.
- **Day 9:** rehearse.
- **Day 10:** share day.

Sources

You must cite at least 2 sources. Use the form: *Author, Title, year*. (See `../sources.md` for examples.)

Safety

- Any project involving plants / food / outdoor work must be supervised.
- **No herbal medicine recommendations.** Modules 10 and 4 give awareness; therapeutic decisions belong to qualified practitioners.

Grading

See `rubric.md`. The project is worth the same weight as the summative quiz.